International Quote SOP

Owner: Jericho Freight	**Effective Date: 08/25/26**
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General Information

Description / Objective	Teach any teammate how to build an ocean or cross-border quote, how Incoterms decide who pays which slice, how landed cost and transit legs are added, and how to print an INTL-Q file.
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Glossary

1. What this quote is
2. How to open it
3. Customer on the quote
4. Title, origin text, destination text, pallets, notes
5. Equipment and weight
6. Incoterms 2020 in kid words
7. Landed cost waterfall math
8. Transit legs math
9. Container utilization
10. Lanes and legs you type
11. Generate and INTL-Q file name
12. Output fields and customer value
13. What to say out loud
14. Common mistakes
15. Definitions

1. What this quote is

1.1 Kid picture

Domestic quotes are one truck. International quotes are a journey with several vehicles: a truck to a port, a ship, maybe customs, then another truck. Each piece is a leg, like chapters in a story.

This builder lets you skip chapters you do not know yet. You may print a lane picture with only ocean rates, or a full landed-cost stack if the customer gave you duty and VAT.

There is no Load Previous Quote on this mode. Save the PDF. If you need the same job again, copy from the last PDF or rebuild the lanes.

2. How to open it

2.1 Click path

Home screen, click International. Header should say International Quote Builder. Generate is a button that sends JSON, not a normal HTML form post. Stay on the page until the quote opens.

3. Customer on the quote

3.1 Optional name

Include customer on quote works the same. There is no previous-quote picker here.

4. Title, origin text, destination text, pallets, notes

4.1 Words, not only ZIPs

Quote Title prints as the document heading, like Cartagena International Quote.

Origin and Destination are free text (city and country). International lanes are not always US ZIP to US ZIP.

Pallet Count is the example size used to scale per-pallet lane prices into a total.

Valid Until defaults to 15 days if blank. Ocean rates move. Notes print at the end.

Route miles override is optional and rarely needed. Most of this quote is not mileage based.

5. Equipment and weight

5.1 The metal box

Pick 20' TEU, 40' FEU, 40' High Cube, or a domestic 53' style box if that is truly the move.

Total weight in kilograms feeds utilization. 1 kilogram is about 2.2 pounds. Do not type pounds in a kg box.

6. Incoterms 2020 in kid words

6.1 Who pays which chapter?

Incoterms are three-letter codes that say who pays for which chapter of the journey, and where the risk jumps from seller to buyer. They are not the freight rate. They are the rulebook.

Check Incoterms 2020 known? only if the customer really named a term. Then pick EXW, FCA, FAS, FOB, CFR, CIF, CPT, CIP, DAP, DPU, or DDP, and whether your customer is the importer (buyer) or exporter (seller).

EXW: buyer pays almost everything from the seller's door. DDP: seller pays almost everything including duty. FOB is a common ocean middle: seller gets the box on the ship, buyer pays ocean and beyond.

The app uses that code to show only the cost lines that role pays. If a combo does not make a landed-cost story (for example some exporter + EXW cases), it will say landed cost does not apply.

7. Landed cost waterfall math

7.1 Stacking dollars in a fixed order

Check Full landed costs known? only if you have real numbers. Empty boxes are skipped.

Goods value (FOB) is what the cargo is worth before international add-ons.

Duty percent and VAT percent are taxes. Dutiable basis CIF means tax is figured on goods + ocean + insurance. FOB basis means tax is figured on goods only.

The full textbook stack, when used, is: goods, plus ocean, plus insurance, equals CIF. Duty applies to the dutiable basis. VAT applies to (dutiable + duty). Then destination inland.

The role waterfall only adds the legs that role pays: origin inland (L), origin port (P1), ocean (O), dest port (P2), dest inland (D), plus duty/VAT if that role is the duty payer. DDP is the rare case where the seller pays duty.

Duty and VAT (CIF basis)

CIF = goods value + ocean freight + marine insurance

duty = dutiable x duty% / 100 (dutiable is CIF, or FOB if you picked FOB basis)

VAT = (dutiable + duty) x VAT% / 100

Tiny example: goods $10,000, ocean $2,000, insurance $100, duty 5%, VAT 19%, CIF basis. CIF = $12,100. Duty = $605. VAT base = $12,705. VAT = $2,413.95. Then add any inland you typed.

8. Transit legs math

8.1 Days you can add, not days we invent from Google

Check Transit times known? then type days for origin truck, origin port dwell, ocean, dest customs/port, dest truck. If you leave a box blank, that leg can use a built-in default (ocean 18 days, and so on) when the plan runs.

Total mean days = sum of the legs you included. The wobble is not added as a simple sum. Independent wobbles combine as the square root of (each wobble squared). That is like two wobbly roads that do not always wobble on the same day.

The printed window is mean plus/minus 1.645 x combined sigma for about 90%. The hint tells you which leg is the widest (often ports).

Combined transit

mean = L + P1 + O + P2 + D (only legs in the plan)

sigma = square root of (1.0^2 + 2.0^2 + 2.0^2 + 2.5^2 + 0.5^2) when defaults are used, about 4.3 days

window = mean +/- 1.645 x sigma

Tiny example: ocean 18, others at defaults. Mean is about 29 days. The window is several days wide. Never sell the low number as a guarantee.

9. Container utilization

9.1 Will it fit?

Floor positions: 20' about 9 pallets, 40' about 20, 40' HC about 23, 53' van about 26.

Cube percent (when the box has a cubic meter rating) = pallets x 2.0 cubic meters / box cubic meters x 100. Two cubic meters is a stand-in for a 48x40 stacked pallet.

Weight percent = kg / payload kg x 100. If over floor positions, tell the customer they need another box or a different equipment type.

10. Lanes and legs you type

10.1 Building the picture

A lane is one path, like Jerome to Oakland to Cartagena. You may add more lanes to compare.

A leg inside a lane is one chapter with a cost. Add legs until the story is complete. Per-pallet costs on legs get multiplied by the example pallet count on the output.

Use Add Lane and Add Leg. Remove ones you do not need. Empty lanes make a thin quote.

11. Generate and INTL-Q file name

11.1 Print

Click Generate International Quote. If the payload is empty, you get sent back. Print Quote names the file INTL-Q plus the number.

Preview mode (if used) can skip saving to history. Normal generate saves and may try CRM in the background. Quotes still print if CRM is off.

12. Output fields and customer value

12.1 Walk the PDF

Summary: Proposed Lanes is the map in words. Customers use it to see you understood the routing.

Cost Breakdowns for N pallets is each lane's money. This is the shopping comparison.

Incoterms block (if known) tells who pays and where risk transfers. This prevents 'I thought you paid ocean' fights.

Landed cost waterfall (if known) is the tax-inclusive stack. Importers need this for true cost, not just ocean freight.

Transit plan (if known) is the day range and the wide-leg hint. Operations uses this to set sail dates.

Container utilization warns about stuffing the box too full or too heavy.

Validity is usually 15 days unless you set a date.

13. What to say out loud

13.1 Simple pitch

You can say: 'This is not one truck price. It is the journey. The Incoterm says which slices are yours. The bottom of the waterfall is the true cost if we included duty and VAT. The day range includes port sitting time, not just sailing days.'

14. Common mistakes

14.1 Watch-outs

Checking Incoterms known and leaving the code blank.

Typing pounds into kilograms.

Selling DDP without duty numbers.

Comparing two lanes with different pallet counts.

Treating the low transit day as a booked vessel cutoff.

Definitions	
Incoterm	A three-letter rule for who pays which part of an international move, and where risk jumps.
FOB / CIF	FOB is goods value. CIF is goods + ocean + insurance. Duty is often figured on CIF.
Landed cost	All-in cost to land the goods, including freight and often duty and VAT.
Leg	One chapter: inland, port, ocean, customs, delivery.
TEU / FEU	Twenty-foot or forty-foot container units.
INTL-Q	Print file prefix for this mode.

Reviewed By:	**Date:**
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